

Effective from: 21 May 2026

Valid until: Further notice

Applies to: All staff travelling for World Vision (WV) business purposes.

This advisory provides context, health guidance, and operational advice in response to the escalating Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) and Uganda.

TRAVEL STANCE

Defer ALL non-essential travel to: DRC and Uganda.

Essential travel may proceed with enhanced precautions following approval from the National Director (ND) in consultation with the RSD. Staff should anticipate disruption and maintain contingency options.

Suspend ALL travel to: Ituri Province, North Kivu, South Kivu, and all officially designated outbreak zones.

Mission-critical travel requires approval from the DRC National Director (ND) or Regional Leader (RL) in consultation with the Regional Security Director (RSD).

In-country personnel:

Defer ALL non-essential movement to outbreak-affected areas. Operational and response-related travel should only proceed where necessary, approved, and conducted in line with public health directives and WV security guidance.

ADVICE

- **Travel necessity:** All planned travel to DRC and Uganda should be critically reviewed and only proceed where operationally essential and appropriately approved.
- **Health precautions:** Avoid close contact with individuals displaying symptoms of illness and avoid contact with bodily fluids, contaminated materials, or human remains. Practice good hand hygiene through regular handwashing and use of alcohol-based hand sanitiser. Avoid consumption of bushmeat.
- **Traveller guidance:** Staff should seek medical advice immediately if symptoms develop during or following travel. Staff returning from outbreak-affected areas should self-monitor for symptoms for 21 days following departure from affected locations.
- **Flight & border disruption:** Enhanced health screening, quarantine requirements, and short-notice travel disruption remain possible across the region. Border closures and additional entry restrictions may be implemented with limited notice.
- **Management responsibilities:** Leaders and managers should review upcoming travel plans and defer non-essential travel to affected areas where operationally feasible.
- **Monitoring & escalation:** Monitor all updates issued by SSR, WHO, local authorities, and WV security teams. Notify your manager or security focal point immediately if assistance is required.

SYMPTOMS AND TRANSMISSION

Bundibugyo virus disease (BVD) is a form of Ebola disease transmitted through direct contact with bodily fluids, contaminated materials, infected individuals, or infected animals. There is currently no approved vaccine or targeted treatment available for the Bundibugyo strain of Ebola virus, making early detection, symptom monitoring, and infection prevention measures particularly important. Symptoms may appear between two and 21 days following exposure and can include:

- Fever
- Fatigue and weakness
- Headache and muscle pain

- Vomiting and diarrhoea
- Abdominal pain
- Unexplained bleeding or bruising in severe cases

Staff experiencing symptoms or requiring medical advice or assistance while travelling internationally should contact the [24/7 AIG emergency assistance hotline](#) for confidential support and referral guidance.

CONTEXT

On 17 May 2026, the World Health Organization (WHO) declared the current Bundibugyo virus disease (BVD) outbreak affecting the DRC and Uganda a Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC). As of 20 May, more than 500 suspected cases and over 130 deaths have been reported, primarily concentrated in Ituri Province in eastern DRC. Imported cases have also been identified in Kampala, Uganda.

The outbreak is considered a high-risk regional public health event due to delayed outbreak detection, ongoing insecurity in affected areas, population displacement, and the absence of an approved vaccine or targeted treatment for the Bundibugyo strain. While the outbreak remains concentrated in eastern DRC, the risk of additional regional spread remains elevated owing to population movement, porous borders, and challenges associated with outbreak containment. Regional monitoring and preparedness measures have also increased in neighbouring countries, particularly South Sudan and Rwanda.

WHO, regional governments, and international partners are scaling up response measures across affected areas. WVI Health is participating in the Global Health Cluster working group to monitor the outbreak alongside ongoing internal health, security, and operational coordination efforts.

World Vision continues to monitor the situation closely in consultation with public health authorities, medical risk providers, and travel risk partners.

RESOURCES

- [World Health Organization \(WHO\)](#)
- [US Centers for Disease Control and Prevention \(CDC\)](#)
- [WV Travel Resources \(wvcentral\)](#)
- [WV Ebola Category 3 Response \(wvcentral\)](#)

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